

Nobuyoshi Shimmen

Engineer

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About Me

Full-stack engineer and PdM with 10+ years of experience building products from zero in startups. I take ownership across the entire product lifecycle — from customer discovery and planning to engineering and support — while keeping business impact as the primary compass. Over the past year I've leaned heavily on LLMs for code generation and Dev/Ops automation, shipping and operating a product as the sole engineer. I thrive at the intersection of business and engineering, and I've seen firsthand why good initial design matters when a product scales.

Experience

PLAID, Inc. /PdM/Engineer

DEC 2025 - PRESENT, TOKYO

- Transitioned to PLAID, Inc. following the acquisition, continuing to own the same advertising reporting product as PdM and Engineer.
- Led PoC for same-day ad data acquisition, partnering with PMM and a key client to design and validate the upgrade from T-1 to real-time data retrieval.
- Organized claude.ai workshops for non-engineer ad operations staff, driving hands-on AI adoption across the team and leading internal validation of new AI tooling.
- Delivered a full data solution for a major retail client — from query analysis to BigQuery data marts and Looker Studio dashboards — enabling data-driven decisions at both operational and executive levels.

agito, Inc. /PdM/Tech Lead

SEPT 2018 - NOV 2025, TOKYO

2024/10 - 2025/11

- Owned the full lifecycle of a new product line as sole engineer and PdM — from planning and client discovery (in partnership with sales) to development, release, and support.
- Built an AI-powered creative generation tool that automatically produces ad banners and copy from landing page content, combining Gemini API and OpenAI API. (TypeScript, Cloud Run, PubSub, Memorystore)
- Developed a semantic ad campaign search engine using BigQuery and Vertex AI vector search, enabling intent-based queries beyond the limitations of the existing keyword system. (TypeScript, Cloud Run, BigQuery, Vertex AI)
- Engineered an ad performance simulation tool that predicts results for new campaigns based on historical data, directly supporting planning and sales workflows. (TypeScript, Cloud Run, BigQuery, Cloud Scheduler)

2023/01 - 2024/09

- As Tech Lead, spearheaded the full rollout of serverless migration across all ad platforms, extending an architecture pattern I had originally designed. Enabled same-day data retrieval across every platform, establishing a key competitive differentiator.
- As PdM, defined and managed the product roadmap in collaboration with the CEO and PMM, keeping business strategy and technical execution aligned. (Team: 8–10 engineers, 5–6 CS)
- Built a one-click report generation flow using the Looker Studio Linking API, reducing client onboarding time.
- Served as the technical point of contact for enterprise onboarding sessions requiring complex system integrations.
- Shipped rapid beta prototypes for third-party integrations (GA4, AppsFlyer, Adjust) using Google Apps Script, enabling fast market validation with minimal engineering resources.

2018/09 - 2022/12 — Joined the PLAID Group in 2022/10

- As a founding engineer, developed the advertising reporting platform from the ground up alongside the CTO.
- Scaled connected ad accounts from 3,000 to 20,000 and grew daily report volume to approx. 200,000/day by resolving scalability bottlenecks through BigQuery partition design and async processing optimization.
- Migrated the existing GAE monolith to a serverless Cloud Run + PubSub async architecture, improving scalability and reducing operational overhead. (Go, PubSub, Cloud Run, Datastore, Memorystore, Cloud Scheduler, BigQuery)
- Built a data mart generator to link ad data with client proprietary data. (Go, PubSub, Cloud Run, Datastore, BigQuery)
- Developed full-stack web applications including a SQL generator for BI tools and an Excel report generator. (JavaScript, Vue.js (Vuetify), PHP (Laravel), GCE)

ubun,inc. / Freelance Engineer

FEB 2021 - APR 2022, TOKYO

- Developed an application targeted for Amazon sellers.
- Responsible for front-end, back-end, and batch processing as a full stack developer.

TVISION Insights Inc. / Freelance Engineer

JUN 2018 - AUG 2018, TOKYO

- Created an internal web application.
- Resourcefully and confidently managed time and projects independently.

Techloco, Inc. / Engineer

OCT 2015 - JUL 2018, TOKYO

- Collaborated in developing an all-in-one marketing tool.
- Proposed and developed an application that allows users to review, comment on website designs on their browsers.

Soldout, Inc. / Marketing Division

APR 2014 - SEP 2015, TOKYO

- Developed Google Apps Scripts, using Salesforce API, and Hubspot API to improve business workflow.

Education

Aoyama University / Bachelor of Business Administration, BBA

APR 2010 - MAR 2014, TOKYO

The University of Vermont / Concentration in Business

AUG 2012 - MAY 2013, BURLINGTON, VERMONT, USA

- 9 month long exchange program through International Partnership & Collaboration

Skills & Interests

Computer Languages

Proficient Level: Go, TypeScript/JavaScript, PHP, HTML/CSS, SQL

Intermediate Level: Node.js

Hobby: Dart, Python, Swift

Infrastructures

GCP

Compute: Cloud Run, GAE, GCE
Data: BigQuery, Cloud SQL, Datastore, Memorystore, Cloud Storage
Messaging: PubSub, Cloud Scheduler
AI/ML: Vertex AI (Vector Search)
Observability: Cloud Monitoring, Cloud Logging, Cloud Build
Other: Firebase
AWS: EC2, S3
CI/CD & Tools: GitHub Actions, Circle CI, Docker, Git
Generative AI: claude.ai, Claude Code, OpenAI API, Gemini API, Vertex AI (Vector Search), LLM Prompt Engineering

Languages

Native Level: Japanese
Business Level: English (TOEIC score 960)

Interests and Hobbies

- Developing entrepreneurial side projects
- Running an independent side service
- Spending time with family
- Studying fitness and working out

Certificates

Udacity/Machine Learning Engineer Nanodegree
2016-2017

Udacity/iOS Engineer Nanodegree
2015

Links

Blog

<https://www.tumblr.com/blog/nobuyoshi-shimmen>

GitHub

<https://github.com/Generalbelly>

LinkedIn

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/nobuyoshi-shimmen-9a8b1a94/>
